

HALLOWEEN

The origin of the Halloween celebration comes from the Celts, who lived 2000 years ago in Ireland, the United Kingdom and North France. They used to celebrate the new year on November 1st because they thought it was the day of the beginning of a dark season and the reason was the end of summer and the harvest. They thought that on October's 31st night the ghosts of the dead returned to earth.



OCTOBER
31

Halloween is celebrated on October 31st. It is the night before the Catholic festival of All Saints and the pagan Celtic festival of Samhain (November 1st). Halloween is also sometimes called All Hallows' Eve or All Hallowtide and can also be written Hallowe'en. Halloween colours are orange and black. Orange is related to harvests because the end of October is the end of the harvest. Black is related to death.

Trick-or-treating is one of the most typical traditions in Halloween night. This custom is imported from the USA and is more popular with young people than with adults. It consists in children dressed up visiting the houses in their neighbourhood asking for a 'trick or treat'. The neighbour gives them sweets or money as a 'treat'. If there is no treat, the children play a trick on the neighbour.



Another important tradition is creating pumpkin lanterns, also known as Jack-o'-lantern. These are pumpkins with the inside removed and eyes, mouth and a nose cut into one side. A candle is placed inside the empty pumpkin and the light creates a scary face effect. People use pumpkin lanterns to decorate their homes at Halloween.